

GA-HR-01

Attendance & Reliability

Standards for punctuality, absence reporting, authorised leave, accurate records, and dependable handover.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Labour Act 11 of 2007 sections 23-27; Employment Contract clauses 5 and 7

01 Purpose

Reliable attendance protects learning time, supervision, team planning, and the safe operation of the school. This policy sets the minimum attendance and communication standards for Gardner staff.

02 Required practice

Employees must:

- Arrive on time, ready to work, and report to the assigned location.
- Follow the approved clock-in, register, or attendance process accurately.
- Notify the employer or immediate supervisor as soon as possible when illness, emergency, or delay may affect attendance.
- For sick leave, give at least two hours' notice where reasonably possible. An emergency or genuine inability to notify in advance must be explained as soon as reasonably possible and will be considered on its facts.
- Remain on duty until responsibility has been properly handed over or permission to leave has been given.
- Complete assigned work and routine deadlines, or raise a barrier early enough for support to be arranged.

03 Leave and absence

An employee's annual leave is taken during official school holidays in accordance with the school calendar. Leave will normally not be taken during a school term unless prior written approval has been received. Employees must follow the applicable leave-request procedure, provide the required notice and supporting documents, and must not assume that a submitted or discussed request has been approved.

04 Records and honesty

Attendance and time records must be complete and truthful. Staff may not ask another person to clock in, sign, or record attendance on their behalf. Falsifying a record is a serious breach of trust.

05 Accountability

Repeated lateness, missed notification, unauthorised absence, unreliable handover, or failure to follow the leave-request procedure may result in coaching or action under the applicable HR process. Employees must provide honest information and participate in any attendance follow-up required by the school. Genuine illness will be treated with care and confidentiality.